



Preparation for Assessment

AcF318: Proposal Document (20%)

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The Project Proposal (20%)



Lancaster University
Management School

The proposal must be in the form of a Powerpoint slide deck, which must then be saved as a pdf file for uploading (to ensure that what I see is what you want me to see)

- No more than 12 slides.
- The word count limit is 500.
- This includes all headers, labels, boxed texts in pictures, or the contents of tables.
- You can use as many pictures or diagrams as you wish.
- We will not count the words on the first slide (if it is simply a title slide) or last slide (if it is simply a page of references).

Do not have bullets everywhere, use them to emphasise list, but not as a substitute for short paragraphs. Since it is being used as a document, not a presentation, the writing needs to be in full sentences that are short, easy to follow, and flow on one from the next, nice and clearly.

For academic rigour, still include one page at the end, with references, in a suitable format.

The Project Proposal (20%)



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The proposal is **not** an analysis of the company, but rather it **must explain**:

- What narrow and specific aspects of that company you will study. Think about the size of a SBU (strategic business unit) so one that deals with a specific product, a specific part of the world, or a certain market. However, instead you might look at a very specific issue such as a sourcing issue in relation to one key resource, or workforce issues, or competitive ethical issues.
- a rationale for your choices based on your understanding of the wider political, social and economic environment. So, explain briefly why the topic you are looking at is useful or important.
- what evidence will be sought to enable your analysis. No need to restate all of the evidence, just give an idea of your intended sources.
- what models or frameworks you will use, and why you think they will be useful. Recommend 1 or 2 only. **DO NOT ACTUALLY DO ANY ANALYSIS IN THIS DOCUMENT.**

Prep for The Project Report



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The proposal you submit will give the module Director the insight needed to see what problems you might face in creating your final report.

This is important, and useful, as it allows you to get feedback on the proposal to feed forwards into the final report document.

For this reason, it is very important to think hard about the company, the topic area, the models you wish to use for your analysis, and then present these clearly in your proposal slide deck.

A way to think about the proposal



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The document you create is called a **Proposal** for a very good reason.

- Imagine you are working for a research firm or a think tank, which carries out **independent reviews** on topics it considers to be important. These reviews then get picked up and used by industry, governments, and published in newspapers or quoted. It is not consultancy.
- This short pitch document is what you are going to present to your boss at the think tank, to explain what company and what topic you want to focus on in the coming weeks. You therefore need to get them to **buy in to your ideas** – why does it matter, how will you do it, where are the sources of data you think you can rely on.
- Do not actually do any analytical work, but instead, be sure you fully understand the models or frameworks you intend to use, then explain **their use and their value** in your setting.